

Goa Travel Guide

Overview

Goa is a coastal state on India's western shore, known for its beaches, Portuguese-era churches, spice plantations, and lively nightlife. It is split into North Goa (party beaches, shacks, markets) and South Goa (quieter, upscale resorts).

Best Time to Visit

The ideal season is November to February, when the weather is pleasant with average temperatures of 20-30 degrees Celsius. March to May is hot and humid. The monsoon (June to September) brings heavy rain and rough seas, so most water sports shut down.

Top Attractions

Baga Beach and Calangute Beach - popular for water sports, shacks, and nightlife.

Basilica of Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral in Old Goa - UNESCO World Heritage churches.

Dudhsagar Waterfalls - a four-tiered waterfall on the Goa-Karnataka border, best visited just after monsoon.

Fort Aguada - a 17th century Portuguese fort with a lighthouse and sea views.

Anjuna Flea Market - held every Wednesday, good for souvenirs and local crafts.

Spice plantations near Ponda - guided tours with traditional Goan lunch.

Local Transport

Renting a scooter or bike is the most popular way to get around Goa; an international driving permit or valid Indian license is required. Prepaid taxis and app-based cabs are also available at the airport. Local buses (kadamba) connect major towns cheaply.

Local Guidelines

Nudity and topless sunbathing are illegal on Goa's beaches despite common misconception. Alcohol is cheap and widely available, but driving under the influence is strictly enforced. Always wear a helmet on two-wheelers - it is mandatory and checked by police.

Approximate Costs

Budget travellers can manage on Rs. 1500-2500 per day (hostel stay, local food, scooter rental).

Mid-range travellers typically spend Rs. 4000-6000 per day for a 3-star hotel and casual dining.

Luxury beach resorts range from Rs. 10,000 to Rs. 25,000 per night.